

defensive line was stabilized, hinging on woods known as the Round Forest. When nightfall brought combat to an end, Bragg felt he had won a great victory. But Union commanders resolved to fight on. Over the next two days Bragg could make no further progress, and by the afternoon of January 2, he had to order Major General John C. Breckinridge to lead his Kentucky Orphan Brigade in a near suicidal assault. Bragg resolved to withdraw the next day, conceding the field to Rosecrans. Union losses were 13,249 out of 43,400 engaged; the Confederates lost 10,266 out of 37,712.



The Slaughter Pen

The site of Sheridan's stiff four-hour resistance to the Confederates was dubbed "the Slaughter Pen" for its gory appearance on the first day of the Battle of Stones River.